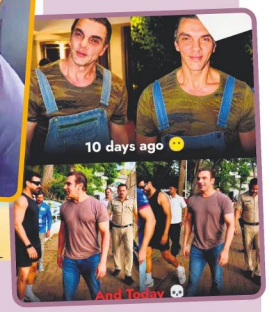




VIDYUT JAMMWAL
Vidyut Jammwal may have questioned fans for not taking action out of concern for Tiger Shroff after the attack on the actor last month. However, it became fodder for parody videos, including an AI-generated clip of Barcelona coach Hansi Flick delivering Vidyut's lines as a team talk after the club lost to Real Madrid on October 25.

SOHAIL KHAN
Sohail Khan's drastic physical transformation became the perfect muse for the internet to use in the Gowardhan ghee meme trend that originated with Saif.

SAIF ALI KHAN
Saif Ali Khan's expressions are a goldmine, and his child-like excitement on getting two-year worth of free ghee supply on Kaun Banega Crorepati in September, led to a professional collaboration between Saif and the brand.



STARS AND THEIR MEME-ENTOS

Many Bollywood celebrities made headlines this year not just for their performances but also for their meme-worthy dialogues and appearances. From Saif Ali Khan's love for ghee to Ravi Kishan's priceless advice, here's a look at some of the biggest meme-ents





SHARVARI
Sharvari's appearance on Samay Raina's India's Got Latent 2 in June got a viral moment with her dance on the song Chai Ki Tapri. It inspired Reels, memes and AI-generated videos, with even the actor partaking in the trend through her Instagram Stories.

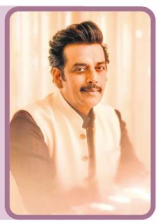
PHOTOS: INSTAGRAM



Compiled by Vishakha Pandit

SALMAN KHAN
If Salman Khan comes on social media, what he does next is anybody's guess. It's been five months since he asked activist Sonam Wangchuk to end his hunger strike, but his words "It's done bro" still echo online in the meme world.

RAVI KISHAN
Whatever Ravi Kishan touches turns into meme-gold, be it his unscripted remarks, advices or entry dances. From "Home from work", to "Money follows my brother!" to his viral Gucci dance, the actor has been the true meme-star of 2026.



Saiyami Kher sees her working Diwali this year as an 'auspicious' sign



S Farah Rizvi
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Actor Saiyami Kher missed Diwali celebrations with her family this year owing to her busy schedule. But she considers it a sign of prosperity. "I'm genuinely happy that I was working. Hopefully, a working Diwali is an auspicious sign and brings me lots of work in the coming year!" she says, adding that she brought in some festive spirit on the set with her team.

While festivals are traditionally celebrated at home, the 34-year-old shares how her family has a tradition of travelling together for Diwali. "It's almost become a ritual to travel with my parents and sister. Last year, we were in Italy, and the year before that, in Bali. It is that time we get to switch off from our individual schedules and make memories as a family," Saiyami shares.

Reflecting on her favourite festive memories growing up, Saiyami recalls, "Some of my fondest Diwali memories are of watching my grandmother prepare all the sweets and savouries; how the elaborate spread and the aroma filled the entire house. As children, we were most excited about sweets and festivities! But as you grow older, you realise that what you really miss is having everyone under one roof."

Speaking about recreating her grandmother's recipes to feel closer to home, she says, "My sister is planning to make some of the sweets my grandmother used to prepare, so hopefully, she'll send some my way! Nobody can quite match my grandmother's cooking, but I'm glad my sister is attempting it. There's something special about recreating family recipes. It's a lovely way of keeping those memories alive."

Parineeti Chopra was the right choice for Reporting Live, says director Dhruv Tripathi

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM



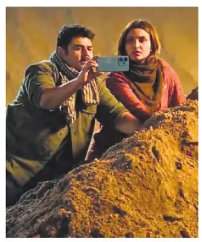
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The way audiences consume news may have changed with the rise of digital platforms, but filmmaker Dhruv Tripathi believes journalism's fundamental responsibility remains the same: bringing the truth to light. "There may be a certain section which is about numbers, but there are also people who are using the digital medium to put out some very hard-hitting and true journalism," he says.

His recent film, the Parineeti Chopra-starrer *Reporting Live*, has received appreciation from audiences, and Dhruv believes Parineeti was the most apt choice for the lead role. "We needed someone who could feel relatable even as a reporter and Parineeti has a certain sense of relatability to her, which has always been one of her unique aspects," he says.

> Parineeti has a certain sense of relatability to her, which has always been one of her unique aspects.
> DHRUV TRIPATHI, Director

The film, which highlights an illegal sand-mining racket run by a ruthless syndicate, grew out of a conversation with co-writer Mihir Jadhav about people stealing sand. The research also uncovered accounts of journalists, IAS officers and policemen who had faced threats or lost their lives while exposing illegal activities. "We realised that there was a much bigger responsibility than just making a crime film. It was about the cost of truth and the fact that there were a lot of ordinary people going against the grain to bring this to light," he ends.



Wearable air purifiers: Do they really work in high AQI?

A range of new-age gadgets offering protection against toxic air have been getting more popular. Experts share if these are effective outdoors, especially during the post-festive season Air Quality Index (AQI) spike

PHOTO: CHATGPT(AI GENERATED FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY)



Aadrika Sominder



PHOTO: ADOBE STOCK

What are wearable air purifiers

Designed as compact pendants, neckbands or clip-on attachments, wearable air purifiers claim to protect a person by releasing negative ions. These ions attach to dust and PM2.5 particles, ideally pushing them away from the face to create a pocket of cleaner air.

The Effectiveness

Evaluating the landscape of clean-air gadgets requires separating medical evidence from commercial hype, say doctors. According to Dr Sunil Rana, Associate Director and Head - Internal Medicine, Asian Hospital, personal and wearable air purifiers cannot match the scientifically backed benefits of physical filtration. "Their weak ionic fields are easily disrupted by indoor air currents and outdoor breezes, making them ineffective in everyday conditions. Ionisers also don't actually filter pollutants out of the air; they only cause particles to settle on nearby surfaces. Some electronic devices also release ozone, which can irritate the lungs and worsen respiratory conditions," says Dr Rana.

Nostril inserts, especially, can distort the nasal valve, force uncomfortable mouth-breathing, and leave the pharynx vulnerable to unfiltered air, says ENT specialist Dr (Major) Rajesh Bhardwaj.

WHAT WORKS

When it comes to outdoor protection, a properly fitted N95, FFP2 or KF94 mask is a far more reliable choice, say doctors. "Check that they seal closely around your nose and cheeks, with no noticeable gaps. A loose surgical or cloth mask is not an equivalent substitute," says Dr Rana.

For indoors, look for a genuine HEPA filter, preferably H13 grade, with an activated carbon bed. The HEPA filter mechanically captures 99.97% of fine particles down to 0.3 microns, while activated carbon adsorbs dangerous gaseous pollutants like nitrogen dioxide and volatile organic compounds.

HOW AIR POLLUTION EXPOSURE AFFECTS YOU

Frequent exposure to polluted air can irritate the nose, throat and respiratory tract. Persistent sneezing, a runny or blocked nose, throat irritation, nosebleeds and headaches are some symptoms people may experience during periods of poor air quality.

"You must be alert to chronic and emergent warning signs. Seek immediate clinical care if you notice progressive shortness of breath during routine walking or when lying flat, persistent central chest pressure, or palpitations. Additionally, if phlegm turns thick, yellow, or green, or if it is accompanied by fever, it indicates a secondary bacterial infection requiring formal medical management," says pulmonologist Dr Neetu Jain, PSRI Hospital.



{ DAILY HOROSCOPE }

Monday, November 09, 2026

Dr Prem Kumar Sharma (Astrologer and Vaastu expert) can be contacted at: **Delhi:** 011-47033152, 40532026 (Sat to Mon); **Panchkula:** 91-172-2562832, 2572874 (Tues to Thurs); **Mumbai:** 09716145644 (Last week of every month)

PREMASTROLOGER | PREMASTROLOGER | ASKPREMASTROLOGER

ARIES
MAR 21-APR 20

A prestigious opportunity can strengthen academic confidence and highlight your capabilities. A flexible work schedule can improve concentration while supporting your personal well-being.
LOVE FOCUS: Sensible advice can help you handle a personal concern smoothly.
LUCKY NUMBER: 2 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Blue

TAURUS
APR 21-MAY 20

Rich foods are best enjoyed in moderation to keep physical comfort steady. A nostalgic family conversation can bring happiness and thoughtful reflection.
LOVE FOCUS: Someone close to you can help restore harmony in personal relationships.
LUCKY NUMBER: 9 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Brown

GEMINI
MAY 21-JUN 21

Professional adaptability can keep your business resilient and competitive in changing conditions. Secure financial platforms can improve money management.
LOVE FOCUS: Thoughtful guidance can deepen mutual respect.
LUCKY NUMBER: 5 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Green

CANCER
JUN 22-JUL 22

Family obligations could feel draining, so protect some time for your own well-being. Clear thinking can support creativity and help you approach the day with greater mental balance.
LOVE FOCUS: Honest emotional expression can bring greater openness to a close relationship.
LUCKY NUMBER: 3 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Grey

LEO
JUL 23-AUG 23

Your contribution at home is likely to be noticed and valued. Luxury spending could strain finances, making essential priorities more important than impulse purchases.
LOVE FOCUS: Financial security can reduce stress and bring greater ease to relationships.
LUCKY NUMBER: 8 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Purple

VIRGO
AUG 24-SEP 23

Family rituals can create comfort and reinforce a sense of togetherness. An official journey could keep you busy while adding variety to your work routine. A steady pace can keep academic progress satisfying.
LOVE FOCUS: Patient listening can make your spouse feel supported.
LUCKY NUMBER: 11 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Maroon

LIBRA
SEP 24-OCT 23

Outdoor exercise can refresh your energy and make physical activity feel more enjoyable. Business owners can use the day for practical planning and future preparation.
LOVE FOCUS: Extra effort from your spouse might not resolve tension.
LUCKY NUMBER: 7 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Peach

SCORPIO
OCT 24-NOV 22

Unexpected financial gains could brighten the day and improve short term monetary comfort. Health awareness can encourage habits that support lasting physical well-being.
LOVE FOCUS: Cheerful moments at home can help maintain harmony.
LUCKY NUMBER: 17 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Saffron

SAGITTARIUS
NOV 23-DEC 21

A recent professional effort is likely to bring you closer to deserved career recognition. Greater attention to fitness may produce noticeable improvement.
LOVE FOCUS: Experienced guidance can bring reassurance in a personal decision.
LUCKY NUMBER: 18 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Orange

CAPRICORN
DEC 22-JAN 21

Financial decisions based on uncertain future income could create unnecessary strain. A younger family member could need patient guidance.
LOVE FOCUS: Family concern might feel supportive without easing every personal pressure.
LUCKY NUMBER: 1 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Golden

AQUARIUS
JAN 22-FEB 19

Endurance training can strengthen stamina and leave you feeling physically empowered. Automated financial tools can improve expense forecasting.
LOVE FOCUS: Avoid impulsive reactions to your spouse's opinion.
LUCKY NUMBER: 22 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Beige

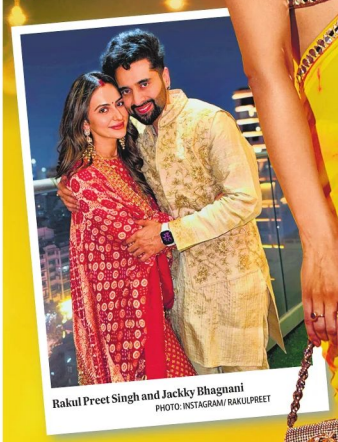
PISCES
FEB 20-MAR 20

A professional idea could strengthen an upcoming project. Intermittent fasting tools can support metabolism when used sensibly. A financial opportunity could create room for future monetary expansion.
LOVE FOCUS: Staying composed can prevent minor family issues from becoming personal tension.
LUCKY NUMBER: 4 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Red

ILLUSTRATION: ADOBE STOCK

Actor Rakul Preet Singh reflects on evolving family traditions, festive celebrations with husband Jackky Bhagnani, and finding a balance between indulgence and fitness during the festive season

HT City Mumbai



Rakul Preet Singh and Jackky Bhagnani
PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ RAKULPREET

'THE FESTIVE WEEK IS ALL ABOUT INDULGING IN SWEETS AND FOOD'

Vishakha Pandit

The festive season has always been a special time for actor Rakul Preet Singh, bringing with it cherished family traditions and good food. While some of the things she looks forward to have evolved over the years, the joy of festive preparations, particularly in the days leading up to and following Diwali, remains close to her heart.

"Diwali has always been one of my favourite festivals. I love how the house is lit up, how you meet your friends and family, enjoy great food, dance and celebrate this beautiful festival of love and light. As kids, what used to be very exciting was bursting crackers," she shares, adding, "The childhood tradition I still look forward to is lighting up the house. Lighting diyas, candles and putting up lights just makes me feel so good. Both Jackky and I love lighting diyas, and he is very much a part of that too," says Rakul.

Beyond the rituals and celebrations, food is an integral part of the festive experience for her. "The entire week of festivities leads to a lot of indulgence in different kinds of sweets, halwas and food," she says.

However, enjoying the festive spread while staying mindful of her fitness routine calls for a little planning. Rakul admits that striking this balance during the festive season can be challenging, especially with celebrations stretching over several days. "It is probably the toughest time of the year to have a balance in your meals and nutrition. But I try my best and pick out two or three days when I will indulge myself. One trick Jackky and I follow is that we finish dinner before heading to parties during the festive time. We then end up snacking rather than eating a very heavy meal. But we never take a complete break from our routine because then it is tougher to bounce back," she explains.

Rakul's revelations

ONE SWEET YOU CAN'T RESIST?
Sweets I can resist, food I can't.

RANGOLI OR LIGHTING DIYAS?
Lighting diyas.

ONE SONG THAT DEFINES THE FESTIVE VIBES?
Jai Jai Ram and Mangal Ram.

ONE PERSON YOU ABSOLUTELY HAVE TO CELEBRATE FESTIVALS WITH?
My family, of course.

FONDEST FESTIVE-TIME MEMORY?
It is really difficult to encapsulate so many memories and find one.

SAREE OR LEHENGA FOR DIWALI?
Either. Whichever is lighter, to be honest!

HOSTING A PARTY OR ATTENDING ONE?
Hosting, any day!

ONE WORD TO DESCRIBE YOUR PERFECT FESTIVE TIME?
Great food, great company, friends and family. That's all!

Our family enjoys eating from the same thali during the festivities: Bhagyashree



PHOTO: PRASHANT SAMTANI

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Actor Bhagyashree, who was seen in two films this year – *The Great Grand Superhero: Aliens Ka Aagman* and *Raja Shivaji* – makes it a point to be home in time for during festival time, no matter where in the world work takes her. This year was no different, as she spent the Diwali surrounded by family and following cherished traditions.

"On Lakshmi Puja day, everyone came together, Diwali for me has always meant family time," she shares. One ritual the family continued this year was the traditional oil bath on Diwali morning, a practice they observe every year. "We soaked khus khus, badam and methi, and extract coconut milk overnight. In the morning, I gave the children (Avantika Dassani and Abhimanyu Dassani) a maalish using these ingredients, which are good for their skin and hair. After Ganeshji's aarti, we performed the children's aarti and blessed them with health, wisdom, happiness, prosperity and success," the 57-year-old says.

The morning rituals were followed by a traditional Maharashtrian lunch, with a spread featuring shrikhand, aloo puri, masale bhaat and jalebis. The dish the family looks forward to most each year is Bhagyashree's simple preparation of varan bhaat. "I add toop, nimbu and namak to the rice and dal, mix everything together and feed them with my hands. Everyone enjoys eating from the same thali. Even my in-laws and Himalaya (husband) wait for it, " she says.

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BHAGYASHREE BREAKS IT DOWN

One sweet you can happily binge on?
Besan ke laddoo and specifically sattu ki barfi that my mum-in-law makes. I also love skrikhand puri.

Who is experimental in the kitchen: you, or the children?
During festivals, everyone just wants to eat!

One thing you always buy for yourself during the festive time?
A new saree for me, new clothes for everyone, and jewellery for Avantika.

Traditional saree or a contemporary festive look?
Saree, anyday.

A party at home or a quiet family dinner?
I prefer a party at home with close friends.

One Bollywood song that gets everyone on the dance floor?
Gallan Goodiyan!

Your ultimate festive-mood: food, fashion or family time?
Family time and food.

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ANYMA

DJ Anyma on India debut: The audience's reactions help me shape my show



DJ ANYMA'S HITS
- Sentient
- Reminding
- Consciousness
- The Sign
- Welcome to the Opera
- Higher Power
- MAGNUS

Vishakha Pandit

Italian DJ and producer Anyma, AKA Matteo Milleri, who is set to make his India debut in Mumbai on November 22, says he has not planned a fixed setlist for his performance.

"Every song is linked to a new progression in the visual narrative, but I am always navigating the show and set differently depending on the country, the venue, and what the audience is reacting to. This way, I have specific moments I'm planning to premiere prepared while retaining the spontaneity that's exciting about electronic music," he shares.

The 38-year-old's approach to live performances has evolved since the release of his debut solo album, *GENESYS*, in 2023, and he is now more focused on the artistic aspect. "Back then, I was reacting and making decisions in real time. Now I've become comfortable with the blueprint and I can focus on the creation of the art itself, versus the time we used to spend figuring out the implementation," he explains.

The Anyma project has also grown significantly in scale since its inception during the pandemic. However, the DJ maintains that the audience remains central to his work. "Anyma started as a creative outlet for me during the pandemic when there was no live music. It's pretty surreal to think of what it's grown into now. My goal has always been to create an intimate, emotional moment with the audience regardless of the size. I'm most fulfilled addressing deeper and more complex themes behind the show than just a traditional concert," he ends.

> I am always navigating the show differently depending on the country, the venue, and what the audience is reacting to. This way, I have specific moments I'm planning to premiere prepared, while retaining the spontaneity.
>
> **ANYMA,** DJ-producer

PHOTO: AMAN NAGOSHE



HT City SHOW STOPPERS
FOR CELEB STYLE, FOLLOW ON INSTA: @htcityshowstoppers

OUTFIT: ISA BY DOLLY WAHAL
JEWELLERY: AIVA JEWELLERY
LOCATION: ITC GRAND CENTRAL, MUMBAI

Krystle feels dressing up is the best part of festivals

Akash Bhatnagar
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For Krystle Dsouza, the festive season was made more special by the professional milestones she has achieved over the past year. The actor gained widespread recognition with the song *Sharara* from *Dhurandhar* in December last year and, in August this year, went on to win the second season of the show *The Traitors*.

"My life has done a full 360 turn in the past one year. Only good things have happened to me," she shares during a shoot with HT City Showstoppers, adding, "When you feel you are hitting rock bottom, there's only one way to go, and that's up. That is what has happened to me in the last year professionally."

With Diwali celebrations behind her and Christmas on the horizon, Krystle is looking forward to more festive cheer. "The best thing about festivals is just dressing up, meeting my friends and eating good food. We all meet often, but we do so in such casual setups and casual looks, but on Diwali, everyone just looks their best," she quips.

While contemporary fashion has its appeal, festive time is an opportunity to celebrate the richness of Indian textiles and craftsmanship for Krystle. "I love Indian textiles and how the clothes are so expressive. The hand embroidery, the fabric, everything is so different for every occasion and festival. When you are ready, you just know which festival it is for," she says.